STATUS REPORT

Guinea: status report

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Guinea's digital commitments have been folded into a mining-led development programme rather than carried by a digital plan of their own: Pillar 3 of Simandou 2040, launched in November 2025, makes digital the backbone of industrialisation across infrastructure, transport and technology, with a target of 20 per cent of GDP for the digital sector, ICT being one of the programme's five pillars, and the state digitalisation agency ANDE was created by decree in April 2022. The sector's own plan, the National Strategy for State Digitalisation and Development of the Digital Economy, runs only to 2027, with the government data centre among its structuring projects under ANDE and the digital economy ministry.

Ownership of delivery has changed twice in six months. The digital portfolio sits in a merged Ministry of Communication, Digital Economy and Innovation, whose minister Mourana Soumah took office in February 2026 and kept it through the presidential reshuffle of 27 July 2026, but was dismissed by presidential decree in August 2026 with no reason given, the ministry's secretary-general holding the portfolio on an interim basis; the same reshuffle put Djénabou Touré at the Ministry of Territorial Administration and Decentralisation, from where she delivered Guinea's address for the Africa Day of Decentralisation and Civil Registration on 10 August 2026, so the civil-registry side of the programme answers to a different minister from the digital economy.

The recurring pattern is a commitment made without the instrument to carry it. Guinea named stronger local data hosting among its digital priorities for 2026 (January 2026), while the only data localisation mandate in law covers credit-bureau data. The payments strategy for the years after 2026 is still to be written: the central bank, with the AfricaNenda Foundation, advertised on 14 August 2026 a four-month consultancy to draft a National Payment Systems and Instruments Strategy for 2027–2030, closing at the end of that month.

The governance base under all of this is not improving. Guinea scores 41.9 of 100 for overall governance in the 2024 Ibrahim Index (2023 data), 42nd of 54 and below the continental average of 49.3, in a decade when the African average rose and Guinea's score did not, and it sits below the African average on 71 of the index's 96 indicators. Its largest gain is in Foundations for Economic Opportunity, up 5.0 points over 2014-2023 to 45.0 of 100, which the foundation attributes to infrastructure and the rural economy.

Legislation and regulation

Mobile money in Guinea falls under the telecoms regulator's supervision: Décret D/2021/092/PRG/SGG of 25 March 2021 makes ARPT the body that regulates and supervises electronic transactions, mobile money among them, and the same decree lets it charge on the electronic-payment traffic it supervises, making the supervisor a

beneficiary of the volume it oversees. The decree sits under Loi L/2016/035/AN, the framework statute for electronic transactions, and adds obligations on e-commerce sellers operating in the country, among them displaying prices in Guinean francs inclusive of taxes and delivery.

What that leaves uncovered is most of the payments estate. Guinea has no payment-systems statute and no national payments council, both of which the World Bank-financed WARDIP project is meant to produce, and which sat at terms-of-reference stage awaiting the Bank's no-objection (2025). Interoperability has no statute of its own either: the World Bank's digital economy diagnostic found the legal and interoperability framework for e-government inadequate and recommended regulating the interoperability of digital payments (2021). Consumer protection exists only as provisions inside the electronic transactions law requiring prices and contract terms to be stated clearly, with no dedicated regime for payments covering electronic money disputes or chargebacks.

The tightening that has happened has come by decree rather than by statute: a presidential decree announced in May 2026 makes cybersecurity audit, certification and incident notification mandatory for public and private entities conducting electronic transactions, again under ARPT's supervision. Where the statute is old, its reading is contested: a telecoms union federation argued in May 2026 that the telecoms law entitles operators holding a global licence to provide fibre to the home, against a restriction imposed on it.

Data protection

Guinea has had a data protection statute for a decade and has never stood up the authority to enforce it: the body provided for in the 2016 cybersecurity and personal data law has never been established, and a draft law to create the Autorité de Protection des Données Personnelles was still before the National Transition Council in 2024, leaving the country with data protection legislation but no enforcement body. The statute itself, Law L/2016/037/AN of 28 July 2016, covers sensitive categories including biometric data and sets out rights of access, rectification and erasure — rights that at present have no regulator to vindicate them.

Localisation is imposed sectorally rather than generally. Under the credit bureau law of 30 December 2019, moving credit databases or their backup sites outside Guinea requires prior authorisation from the central bank, granted only where the host country guarantees security measures equivalent to or exceeding Guinea's, and no comparable mandate applies in other sectors. Beyond that, the government named stronger local data hosting among its priorities for 2026, while the WURI governance framework Guinea signed with other West African pilot states in April 2023 set cross-border data-sharing and mutual recognition arrangements for identity credentials that no domestic regulator supervises.

Regional collaboration

Guinea belongs to the continent's cross-border payment rail without using it: it participates in the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System but has recorded no transaction on it (2025). Its other regional payments work has stalled: the central bank attended an evaluation meeting on the ECOWAS EPSS integrated payment project in July 2024 and then removed the project from its strategic priorities for 2025.

The regional identity track has thinned from both ends. Guinea's WURI project closed on 28 June 2024, two years ahead of schedule, and its early exit leaves Côte d'Ivoire as the programme's advancing partner, so Guinea no longer builds its foundational identity inside the regional framework. That framework has itself contracted: Mali, Burkina Faso and Niger severed their ECOWAS ties in 2024 and have since launched Alliance of Sahel States biometric credentials of their own, starting with a common passport in January 2025; one of the three borders Guinea.

What does cross the border is fibre: Guinea and Sierra Leone have interconnected their national backbones at the Pamelap crossing under the two countries' 2024 Digital Pact, and Guinea's officials joined Liberia's and Sierra Leone's in June 2026 in a consensus to commercialise spare fibre capacity on the TRANSCO CLSG power transmission network through a regional consortium of licensed operators.

Regional money is moving elsewhere. The World Bank's second WARDIP phase, announced on 11 March 2026, covers Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone, not Guinea, which is in the first such operation with The Gambia, Guinea-Bissau and Mauritania. The bloc's own budget offers little: in the ECOWAS Community budget for 2026-2028 the Youth Entrepreneurship in ICT programme line records nil from 2024 through the 2028 estimates.

The commitments keep arriving. Ministers, Guinea's digital minister among them, adopted the ECOWAS Digital Sector Development Strategy 2024-2029 at Cotonou on 4 October 2024 and urged member states to keep working towards full implementation of the ECOWAS roaming regulation by all mobile operators by the end of 2025; a regional digital roadmap followed in January 2026, committing the bloc to a digital single market with interoperable fintech and a unified identity layer.

Standards

The central bank publishes the regulatory framework for payment systems and instruments, covering real-time gross settlement, the automated clearing house and Swift, among them the 2017 instruction on real-time gross settlement, and its migration of the RTGS to the ISO 20022 messaging standard, launched on 3 June 2024, has been held up by unpaid invoices to the supplier and prolonged customs clearance.

The state digitalisation agency publishes its interoperability rules and reference standards, and the biometric civil registry and national identity system run on the open-source MOSIP platform with TECH5 biometrics, while the exchange layer those systems would plug into remains at preparatory stage: Guinea held a GovStack workshop in April 2026 under the World Bank's regional digital integration project to establish an interoperability foundation for digital public services. Sectorally, the national digital health strategy includes standards and interoperability among its action areas.

Regional specification remains an objective rather than a standard in force: the WURI programme's supervisory committee assessed the harmonisation of technical specifications among participating countries in March 2026, toward mutual recognition of identity credentials across the region.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The authorities closed channels in September 2026: the communication authority banned France 24 on every broadcast and online platform, withdrew its correspondents' accreditation and ordered the telecommunications regulator to enforce it, then banned ten web TV channels and two news sites for operating online without authorisation.

The sharpest public criticism of Guinea's identity programme in 2026 came from inside it. In July 2026 the firm deploying the biometric civil-registration system alleged publicly that fees not provided for in the regulations were being charged at enrolment centres, despite official declarations that biometric documents are free, and asked the territorial-administration and security ministries for unannounced inspections of enrolment centres, disciplinary and where warranted criminal sanctions, a national information campaign restating that the documents are free, and a freephone reporting line; neither ministry had responded as at publication.

The room for that kind of argument has been narrowing. Digital Freedom is one of Guinea's ten most deteriorated Ibrahim Index indicators, down 19.7 points over 2014-2023 to 40.6 of 100 in 2023 and 35th of 54; and while freedom of expression and belief at 58.5 of 100 (30th of 54) and media freedom at 56.1 (23rd) remain among the country's stronger rights scores, both fell over the same decade, by 11.2 and 7.2 points.

What the public can see of digital decisions is thin. Guinea ranks among its own worst indicators on disclosure of public records, and on the identity programme specifically, the July 2026 memorandum covering the security of the national identity register was announced with no value or duration. Officials' own account of what citizens face is administrative: at the August 2026 civil-registration commemoration, registry officials named information gaps and material constraints as barriers to citizens obtaining civil-status documents.

Finance

Financial sustainability

The state's own money carries 49.4 per cent of the digital lines in Guinea's 2025 initial finance law as appropriated, GNF 320.4 billion of GNF 648.0 billion, against 39.7 per cent of GNF 637.8 billion in 2024.

The movement is on both sides. External money for digitising and securing the land cadastre stood at GNF 192.2 billion in 2024, and for the agro-pastoral digitalisation project at GNF 126.2 billion; in 2025 they fell to GNF 160.0 billion and GNF 46.5 billion, while the treasury's line for modernising the tax directorate's information system rose to GNF 52.5 billion from GNF 8.0 billion. The 2025 law prints its external lines, among them GNF 23.4 billion for the regional digital integration programme, without naming a funder; that programme's USD 60 million IDA credit to Guinea sits in a first phase that runs to 2028.

Guinea has put a new own-source instrument in place: a decree of 21 May 2026 sets a Digital Compliance Fee of 3% on foreign streaming, cloud, software, digital advertising and e-commerce services, moving to tiered rates of 1.5% to 7% after twelve months, and creates a Digital Sovereignty Fund financed mainly from it for infrastructure, cybersecurity, training and innovation. The older one is in the telecoms statute: the 2015 law finances universal service from an operators' contribution that the regulator collects into a separate account, with collection and disbursement left to two presidential decrees.

The central bank is fitting out and certifying a Tier III data centre of its own from its own resources (January 2026).

Guinea opened 2026 on provisional twelfths that carried the 2025 appropriations forward, until the 2026 initial finance law was enacted in March 2026.

MoUs and other agreements

Guinea's newest identity agreement was announced without its terms: ONECI and NG Tech Innovation signed a memorandum of understanding in Conakry on 24 July 2026 covering a national interoperability and identity-verification platform built over the Registre national des personnes physiques, under the Diama Djigui programme, and was announced with no value or duration (July 2026).

Older signatures have more behind them. Guinea's national payment switch is being stood up under a memorandum between the central bank and AfricaNenda signed on 5 December 2024, with Guinéenne de Monétique as partner, and the Guinea–Sierra Leone fibre interconnection is executed under the two countries' 2024 Digital Pact, a bilateral framework for digital integration. Visa opened talks with the Finance Ministry about digital payments in April 2026.

New investments

China Eximbank is financing Guinea's Safe City surveillance programme with a concessional loan of CNY 385,329,021, about USD 54 million, across 324 sites in eight cities (2025). MIGA holds two risk guarantees behind Orange's Guinean subsidiaries: EUR 366.33 million issued on 18 December 2023 to Sonatel of Senegal over its equity in Orange Guinée, about USD 373 million for the telecoms component, and about USD 26.5 million over the mobile money arm, Orange Finances Mobiles Guinée. Both are political risk cover, not money disbursed.

Guinea is one of two beneficiaries of the World Bank's USD 122 million WURI Phase 1 identification programme, 2018 to 2026, and one of four in the USD 266 million first phase of the Western Africa Regional Digital Integration Program, 2023 to 2028, both whole envelopes shared with other countries. Its own allocation there is a USD 60 million IDA credit set out in the appraisal document of 7 November 2023; Guinea is not in the second phase announced in March 2026 for Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone. USAID is funding the Notre Santé health programme with about USD 29 million to 2028, including DHIS2. The African Development Bank names Guinea in an XDR 6,060,000 grant (about USD 8 million) for West African unique bank identification, 2023 to 2026, and a pipeline regional health grant, 2026 to 2030.

Ten digital-sector commitments touching Guinea are on record, five to the country directly and five regional operations naming it, spanning 2018 to 2030. The direct five come to about USD 543 million as at August 2026, roughly USD 400 million of it risk cover rather than money moving. Four are concessional loans, three grants, two guarantees and one equity, and the Orange Guinée guarantee is the largest single live commitment. Connectivity and digital payments take three each, one each to identity, sectoral information systems, the ICT industry and innovation; nothing goes to data storage, cybersecurity or digital skills. MIGA leads by value, ahead of China Eximbank and USAID; the World Bank is the most consistent presence, funding a USD 60 million broadband allocation and naming Guinea in two regional programmes worth USD 388 million (August 2026).

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Guinea signed the construction and maintenance agreement for MEDUSA Africa in May 2026, committing it to a second submarine cable landing with the state landing-station operator GUILAB as landing party, after some thirteen to fifteen years of dependence on a single cable, the ACE system, now saturated.

Guinea has moved from one submarine cable landing to two further cables under commitment within roughly a year (June 2026).

Facebook, YouTube and TikTok have been blocked since 28 July 2026, with no authority acknowledging it; internet providers and mobile operators say the decision was not theirs, and a consumer union reports WhatsApp restricted too (August 2026).

A fibre backbone of nearly 12,000 km now reaches all administrative regions, twenty more regional digital hubs are under construction, and more than 600 unserved white zones are the priority for 2026 (2025). It was interconnected with Sierra Leone's at Pamelap in June 2025, SOGEB to Leonecom, at 42.5 Gbps with a 100 Gbps upgrade planned, and Guinea's officials joined Liberia's and Sierra Leone's in a June 2026 consensus to commercialise spare fibre on the TRANSCO CLSG power network, with a roadmap to put the capacity into operation before the end of 2026. Univ Connect had 13 of 17 target universities and institutes connected at its December 2025 launch.

Reach has improved faster than use. 4G networks covered about 78 per cent of the population (2023) and mobile connections were equivalent to 95.1 per cent of the population at the start of 2025, but 26.5 per cent of Guineans were using the internet at that date. The Ibrahim Index shows the same split: Internet & Computers at 10.0 of 100 in 2023, 48th of 54 and among Guinea's ten worst measures, against Mobile Communications as its fourth most improved indicator of 96 over the decade to 2023.

The state is now an operator as well as rule-maker: MTN's Guinean business, with just over 3 million subscribers, passed to the state in a deal made official on 30 December 2024, and a presidential decree of 11 December 2025 made the state sole owner of Areeba Guinée, the company trading as MTN Guinée, with the status of a public body. It pressed Orange Guinée publicly in July 2026 to improve network quality, extend coverage and cut the cost of access, while the telecom union threatened strike action in May 2026 over restrictions on fibre-to-the-home provision and the regime for Wifi-Zone operators.

Data Storage

Guinea's national data centre is built and not yet working: a year after it opened in Conakry in September 2025, certified Tier III by the Uptime Institute, to host national data under national control, the prime minister found it still not fully operational, about 90% complete on nearly US$10m of investment with one payment outstanding (September 2026). The state secured sovereign management of the .gn country domain in 2025, the year of the opening. The facility is a named structuring project of the National Strategy for State Digitalisation to 2027, overseen by the state digitalisation agency ANDE and the Ministry of Posts, Telecommunications and Digital Economy.

The rule on where data must sit is far weaker than the place now built to hold it. Stronger local data hosting is among the government's digital priorities for 2026 (January 2026), and the one binding mandate on the books is sectoral: credit databases and their backup sites may leave Guinea only with prior central bank authorisation, under the 2019 Credit Bureau Law. So the sovereignty being built is physical — a building, a domain, a landing station — well ahead of the law that would oblige anyone to use it.

Energy

Guinea's grid reached 53 per cent of the population (2025), close to the 55 per cent its National Least-Cost Electricity Access Program targets for 2027, with grid access at about 89 per cent in urban areas and about 21 per cent in rural areas in 2021. That gap is the ceiling on any rural digital service, and it is being addressed partly off-grid, through privately operated hybrid mini-grids planned for 26 remote rural localities under the World Bank's second electricity access project, with the rural electrification agency AGER supporting rural electrification (2025).

Connection is not the same as supply. Daily electricity cuts in Conakry left cybercafé computers switched off through the August 2026 vacation season, the period of peak student demand for computer training and online applications. Generation leans heavily on water: renewables account for around 66 per cent of installed capacity, overwhelmingly hydropower (2023), which makes available power seasonal in a way a data centre load is not.

Price is the part that looks best and is least secure. Residential tariffs of roughly 107 to 453 Guinean francs per kilowatt hour are among the lowest in West Africa, and household spending on electricity runs at about 1.2 per cent of monthly income at the subsidised tariff actually charged — a share that would pass 10 per cent at full cost-recovery tariffs (2018). On the Ibrahim Index, Access to Energy scored 22.8 of 100 in 2023, 39th of 54, after a rise of 7.1 points over 2014-2023, and Infrastructure remains one of Guinea's three worst-scoring sub-categories at 28.9 of 100, 40th of 54, even after gaining 9.5 points across the same decade.

Technical Capacity

The clearest test of Guinea's engineering bench so far is one it did not pass: the institutional arrangements behind the foundational identity system were still not fully consolidated in Guinea when the World Bank-financed project supporting it closed in mid-2024. That closure came in June 2024, two years early, with undisbursed identification financing cancelled at the government's request and re-engagement left to a later, more appropriate financing instrument.

The successor arrangement is being built with skills transfer written into it: the RNPP identity-verification platform signed in July 2026 comes with NG Tech Innovation's technical teams deployed in Conakry to transfer skills to national staff. Elsewhere authority is being drawn to the top: the president announced in August 2026 that he would personally follow the GEDA decrees-and-orders platform from his own office to speed up processing.

Cybersecurity

A presidential decree announced on 21 May 2026 makes cybersecurity audit, certification and incident notification mandatory for every public and private entity conducting electronic transactions in Guinea, supervised by the telecoms regulator ARPT. An incident affecting many users requires an initial alert within 24 hours and a detailed report within 72; security audits fall due every three years; foreign companies serving Guinean residents are caught by it; and the resulting audit reports stay confidential. That last provision matters more than it looks: the regime creates an evidence base about the state of the country's systems that nobody outside ARPT will ever see.

The institutions the decree assumes are still arriving. The digital ministry said in its May 2025 stocktake that it had begun setting up a national computer emergency response team and security operations centre and a national public key infrastructure. The statutory base is older than either: Law L/2016/037/AN of 28 July 2016 on cybersecurity and the protection of personal data doubles as the country's general data protection statute, and its provisions are set out in this report's governance chapter.

Guinea scored 56.55 of 100 on the ITU Global Cybersecurity Index, up from 20.53 in 2020 (2024) — a middling result that predates the 2026 decree. Regionally, ECOWAS ministers adopted a directive on confidence-building measures in the cyber and ICT field in October 2024, urging member states including Guinea to implement it without delay once published.

DPI

Data Exchange

The only interoperability layer to reach production in Guinea is a payments rail: NimbaPay was launched on 22 July 2026 to let money move instantly between banks, electronic money institutions and microfinance institutions nationwide. Government systems are not joined in the same way. Guinea still lacks a secure, unified system for exchanging data across ministries and agencies, and platforms such as eTax and the foreign trade single window work in isolation, without shared APIs or interoperability standards (2025).

What is plumbed is bilateral and sectoral. The SYNERGUI business registration platform coordinates company creation across the commercial registry, the tax authority's taxpayer number and the social security fund in a single workflow, and the 2024 upgrade plan for the tax administration system behind the eTax portal provides for a joint tax and social security declaration alongside electronic VAT invoicing. The foreign trade single window is interconnected with commercial banks, the central bank, customs and the port authority. The electoral roll grew ahead of the polls of 31 May 2026 through the addition of newly eligible adults and the recovery of enrolment records that had not been synchronised, and a January 2026 agreement between the electoral administration and

the civil status office makes the National Register of Physical Persons the single official source for identifying voters. Guinea's border system faces outward: the largely biometric PISCES X border control platform synchronises watch-list and immigration data with INTERPOL, IOM MIDAS and US Customs and Border Protection.

The building blocks remain paper commitments. The state digitalisation agency publishes an interoperability rules and standards framework, and convened a World Bank-supported workshop in April 2026 that named passport issuance and identity documents among the priority services still to be brought into a government-wide exchange; a GovStack workshop followed the same month under the regional digital integration project. No public or private service had been linked to the foundational identity system by March 2025. An X-Road exchange platform run by the digitalisation agency was shown to the Prime Minister in August 2026 as in progress, not in production.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Guinea's foundational identity pilot issued only about 8,000 unique identification numbers before the World Bank-financed project supporting it was wound up, and the national identity card was established by a 1995 decree. It closed on 28 June 2024, two years early, undisbursed identification financing cancelled at the government's request. World Bank monitoring recorded zero digital authentications performed by service providers as of March 2025, and no public or private service had been linked to the foundational identity system by then.

The legal architecture is nonetheless demanding. A dedicated identification law adopted on 25 October 2023 establishes a personal identification number and biometric procedures; under the April 2025 decree governing the register it creates, every individual must hold a number generated through it when dealing with any public or private administration. The World Bank cautions that Guinea's arrangements for identification remain unconsolidated and that the 2023 laws "did not fully reflect the principles of identification for sustainable development".

Enrolment has restarted under a domestic institution. A nationwide biometric census for civil registration was launched on 15 April 2025, and Sanoyah commune began issuing biometric birth certificates and enrolling citizens for the biometric identity card in March 2026, with 2,000 certificates allocated to a first phase on the same MOSIP and TECH5 stack, with the birth certificate as the foundational document for the card. The office signed a memorandum of understanding on 24 July 2026 with the domestic firm NG Tech Innovation on the security of the national identity register, announced with no value or duration. Coverage has long been low: only about a fifth of citizens required to hold a national identity card had one (2013), and the ease of obtaining one scores 53.4 of 100, 18th of 54, down 8.1 points since 2014 (2023). Identity checks are also being built into a mass service: a June 2026 presidential decree provides for a national platform certifying the identity of SIM cardholders and telecoms users.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Guinea's national instant payment system was launched as NimbaPay on 22 July 2026 through Guinéenne de Monétique, with support from the Mojaloop Foundation, AfricaNenda and Thitsa Works, to let money move instantly between banks, electronic money institutions and microfinance institutions nationwide. Design work had opened only seven months earlier, at a stakeholder workshop on 18 December 2025, and the switch was stood up under a central bank memorandum with AfricaNenda signed on 5 December 2024. The rail was built on open source expressly so that the state retains control of the infrastructure and can support local fintech firms.

The demand side is the constraint. The central bank stated in July 2026 that more than 70% of payments are still made in cash even at merchants already equipped with electronic payment solutions, and about 26 per cent of adults held an electronic money account (November 2025), against 11 licensed electronic money institutions, up from 6 a year earlier. Access to banking services is among Guinea's ten worst-scoring Ibrahim Index indicators at 11.5 of 100, 37th of 54 (2023). New entrants arrived just before the rail: Coris Bank International launched a bank-issued e-

money service in February 2026 and the non-bank operator BGB Solutions launched the KS-Wallet application in April 2026, while operators had already bridged the two rails bilaterally, with the Banque pour le Commerce et l'Industrie in December 2025 and the Banque Nationale de Guinée in March 2026.

The state is both a user and a laggard. Trésor Pay launched on 22 December 2025 as a central platform for paying administrative fees, duties and charges owed to the state through electronic money, nearly nine years after Orange Money began collecting motor vehicle tax with reconciliation to the Treasury in March 2017; payments from the state have faltered, civil servants still paid in cash having gone without their April and May 2024 salaries after a December 2023 circular moved pay onto bank accounts. Governance lags the machinery: the country had no payment-systems statute and no national payments council in 2025, a 2027–2030 strategy was only put out to consultancy tender on 14 August 2026, and Guinea had recorded no transaction on the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System (2025).

The regional digital integration project called on 1 October 2026 for a firm to design and implement a national payment scheme over nine months, covering governance, rules, security and a pilot, with expressions of interest due 23 October.

Registries

Guinea's registries fail at the counter rather than in the database: a national stockout of the secure paper on which the digitised birth certificate is printed left almost every commune, in Conakry and the interior alike, unable to issue digital birth extracts for about a month (August 2026), because the certificate can only be printed on that substrate, so a supply failure halts issuance nationally regardless of how complete the underlying data is.

Civil registration is the register that has moved. Birth registration completeness rose from 28 per cent in 2018 to 64 per cent in 2023, even as the Ibrahim Index scores civil registration at 50.0 of 100, 31st of 54, down 12.5 points since 2014 — the steepest ten-year fall of any indicator in its public administration sub-category (2023). The digital layer is thin: an EU-funded pilot run by Enabel with DXC Technology has put the civil registry of ten communes into a national digital database, with more than 105,000 records migrated (2023). The population register is by decree fed from the national civil status register; an extension run by the identity office and the elections directorate opened in September 2026, with a first identity-verification platform due by the end of 2026.

Everything else stands apart. Formal land registration is minimal, with an estimated 2.5 to 3 per cent of landowners holding a registered title (2022); full digitalisation of the land cadastre was announced by the Minister of Urbanism in 2026. The mining cadastre, by contrast, has been a public online register since 2017, and company records are searchable through the OHADA regional registry. The unified social registry holds more than 977,000 households and 4.86 million individuals identified as living in extreme poverty (2023); a 2019 decree created it as the single gateway for social-protection programmes. The electoral roll was presented as a permanent biometric file in July 2025 and stood at 6,948,894 voters ahead of the double poll of 31 May 2026. Underneath all of them, the government was working with the start-up FindMe to pilot digital addressing in 2025.

Sectoral management information systems

The clearest measure of what Guinea's ministry systems hold is the payroll: a biometric audit found that of roughly 277,000 registered civil servants only about 130,000 were confirmed biometrically (November 2025), and the government puts savings since 2024 at 233 billion Guinean francs. That register is not yet anchored to anything: the Prime Minister has pressed that it "must integrate a unique personal identification number".

Health is the best-instrumented sector and still runs on paper at the point of care. DHIS2 has been deployed across all health districts since 2022, though data quality and server security weaknesses persist and cross-system exchange is not operational; in rural areas community health workers record visits on paper, and the records reach the district health office each month to be delivered by hand or typed into spreadsheets (2025). Supply-chain visibility is thinner: as of March 2022 only 59 of 444 health centres had implemented the electronic logistics system for vaccine stock, four of them rural. A workshop on the interoperability of health information systems, meant to strengthen the national health information system, was held in November 2025.

Revenue administration is furthest along. The tax authority has run the eTax portal for filing and paying taxes online since September 2020, and the social security fund launched an online contributions platform in July 2025.

Elsewhere the systems are absent. The last published security ministry statistical yearbook was compiled from forms filled in from station registers, some of them missing or poorly kept (2018); the police's automated fingerprint identification system in Conakry has digitised the paper fingerprint archive, for the only forensic department in the country trained to process prints. The government cancelled the World Bank disbursement-linked results that would have required school-level data to be entered into a national database for at least 90 per cent of schools (2024).

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Thirty-nine public service applications were deployed in 2025, and passport issuance was fully digitised through a unified portal. The government runs a central services portal and an e-government applications portal offering online access to civil registration, biometric identity card, passport and driving licence services with account-based login, and scored 0.4006 on the UN E-Government Development Index in 2024.

At least seven distinct government digital platforms entered service or procurement between June 2025 and August 2026 — the digital legal gazette, the online social contributions platform, a vehicle-attestation platform, LANDAYA, TELEMO, GEME and GEDA. The two August 2026 launches are internal state-process tools built around control and traceability, a different shape from the one-stop-shop and e-procurement builds.

Businesses have gained the most. LANDAYA launched in January 2026, issuing industrial administrative documents and permits within a 72-hour service standard; company registration runs through the APIP one-stop shop, which issues the RCCM commercial registration; and TELEMO, the national public-procurement platform digitising the full procurement cycle, launched in Conakry on 22 May 2026. A single window for public services, modelled on Azerbaijan's ASAN centres, was agreed as a partnership in March 2026 and sits inside a nine-project package the public administration ministry presented in May 2026, alongside modernisation of the state HR systems, a mapping of the administration, an inventory of its personnel IT systems and digital-skills training for civil servants.

Attention at the top has turned inward. President Doumbouya announced on 14 August 2026 that he would personally monitor GEDA, the platform managing decrees and ministerial orders, from his own office, to speed administrative processing and the Simandou 2040 programme; the same week GEME was presented to digitise state mission orders, control their cost, frame allowance payments and reinforce post-mission reporting, with no budget, vendor or timetable stated. For citizens without a connection of their own the service stops earlier than the portal: those who depend on Conakry cybercafés to take computer training or submit job applications cannot reliably finish, because both the electricity and the connection are intermittent. The civil service minister presented the one-stop public-service counter project to the mayors of Conakry's 13 communes. The procurement regulator and the World Bank reviewed the e-procurement platform, in a new phase of use since September 2026, with the price reference list and partnerships not yet integrated and a new procurement law in draft.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Guinea is running the digitalisation of civil registration as a limb of decentralisation rather than as a system of its own: the programme covers renewed governance of the country's 375 communal councils, the Conakry-specific FODECCON fund and the national FNDL and FODEL local-development funds, and work has begun on a second tier that would make the regions decentralised collectivities in their own right (August 2026).

What a commune or a prefecture runs on its own account is a separate question, and the foundational layers are still to be built: full digitalisation of the general land cadastre was set as a ministerial priority only in February 2026, and the government was piloting digital addressing with the start-up FindMe in 2025.

A revenue-management tool tested in Benin was presented at the Conakry governorate on 25 March 2025 for piloting in the capital's 13 urban communes, Coyah and Kindia, with financing still to be found.

Rural digital data capture

In June 2024 Guinea's government cancelled, for implementation delays, the disbursement-linked results in a World Bank-financed basic education project that would have required school-level information to be entered by mobile technology into a national database for at least 90 per cent of schools, with dashboards in use by at least a fifth of decision-makers. The payments were tied to building that capability, and they were given up.

Health follows the same shape: community health workers in rural areas record visits on paper, with the records delivered or typed up at the district health office each month (2025), and the electronic vaccine-stock system had reached barely any rural centres by March 2022. Police and gendarmerie stations work from registers, some of them missing or poorly kept, from which the last published security yearbook compiled its national totals (2018). The counterweight is civil registration, the one thing being captured digitally where it happens: biometric enrolment centres have been deployed into rural prefectures since the national programme opened in April 2025, though its implementing decree lets registrars record events either on paper or electronically, and a donor-backed programme is putting offline tablet records into selected rural health centres (2025).

Rural governance itself reads well on the Ibrahim Index. Rural Representation and Participation is Guinea's most improved of all 96 indicators, up 34.3 points over 2014-2023 to 78.1 of 100 in 2023, twelfth of 54, and Rural Economy is its second-best sub-category at 67.8 of 100 in 2023, fifteenth of 54, on the largest ten-year gain of any sub-category. The exception is Rural Market Access, the only one of the four rural indicators to have fallen, down 10.3 points to 53.5 of 100 in 2023. None of that is measured by what a rural office can record, and the gap between urban and rural grid access and the zones still outside any network set the ceiling on how far it could change.

Technology

AI

Government AI has no shared data layer to run on: Guinea still lacks a secure, unified system for exchanging data across ministries and agencies (2025). What exists sits at a remove from deployment. ECOWAS adopted a regional digital roadmap in January 2026 that commits its member states, Guinea among them, to developing a Regional AI Governance Framework.

ICT Industry

When Guinea awarded the build of its national vehicle-attestation platform in August 2025, the work went to two Ivorian startups, SIIN and DIGITECH GROUP. The larger systems are foreign in the same way at the financing end: the Safe City urban surveillance programme, covering cameras, command centres and security management platforms across eight cities, is carried by a China Eximbank concessional loan (2025).

The state has meanwhile become an operator itself, taking over MTN's Guinean business at the end of 2024 and becoming its sole owner by decree in December 2025. The digital ministry's May 2025 stocktake counted a Technopark at Sonfonia among the digital-economy projects on its books. The clearest Guinean-founded firm of any scale in the sector works across the region: Cauridor, a cross-border payments company founded in Guinea in 2022 and operating in 36 African countries, hired a former Flutterwave executive as chief operating officer in April 2026. Domestically, the movement is in who competes rather than who builds — Coris joined the mobile money market in February 2026 alongside the operator-led services, and the state launched LANDAYA in January 2026 to issue industrial permits digitally.

The regulatory setting these firms work in is the better half of a weak picture: business and competition regulation scores 56.7 of 100 and ranks 21st of 54 African countries in the 2024 Ibrahim Index, up 1.8 points, while the wider business and labour environment scores 36.3 and ranks 42nd after a 1.5-point fall (2023).

Innovation ecosystem

Guinea ranked 133rd of 139 economies in the 2025 Global Innovation Index. The supporting network is correspondingly small: three organisations in the country appear in the AfriLabs pan-African hub directory — Trustee Sas, Dreams Tech Hub and Incubateur Saboutech — working with start-ups in ICT, renewable energy, agribusiness and digital education (2025).

Capacity

Literacy

Guinea's education score stood at 40.4 of 100 in 2023, 42nd of 54 African countries and up only 1.5 points across the decade, with equality in education at 24.8 placing it 50th of 54, enrolment at 29.4 after a fall of 3.2 points, and quality at 28.7. The teaching workforce is the exception to that record: human resources in education reached 89.1 in 2023, 18th of 54 and almost twenty points higher than in 2014, a measure of staff numbers and qualifications rather than of what pupils come away with.

The classrooms are being wired ahead of what they can record. 585 schools had been connected to the internet under the GIGA programme by 2025, with 2,200 targeted for 2026, while the World Bank-financed result that would have put school-level data from at least 90 per cent of schools into a national database was cancelled (2024).

Training and skills

Formal computing education is available and privately supplied: nine private institutions list computer engineering, computer science or MIAGE licence programmes on the national admissions portal (2025). On the state's own side, digital-skills training for public administration staff sits in the nine-project package announced in May 2026 to modernise government systems, alongside a mapping of the administration and an inventory of its personnel IT systems.

Below that, training runs through Conakry's cybercafés, where students seeking computer training cannot reliably finish what they start because the electricity and the connection both fail (August 2026).

An operator's foundation and a UN agency signed a protocol in Conakry on 5 October 2026 to equip 50 schools in six regions with connected learning hubs and train 500 adolescents in science, technology and digital skills; no budget or delivery date is stated.

Research institutions

The university system is being connected: Univ Connect, run by the digital agency ANSUTEN, is linking 17 universities and higher-education institutes, 13 of them already live at its launch in December 2025, and the programme had reached more than 80,000 students and staff (2025).

Inclusion

Access to services

Guinea's National Register of Physical Persons decree gives foreign nationals resident or staying in the country, Guineans living abroad, and anyone declaring themselves a refugee or seeking refugee status an express right to be registered. The national identity card does not follow it: under its 1995 decree the card is issued only to Guinean nationals.

Officials name the barriers themselves. Civil-registry officials put the obstacles to obtaining civil-status documents down to information gaps and material constraints (August 2026). The material constraint has an exact form: communes in Conakry and the interior alike have been unable to issue digitised birth extracts for want of the secure paper they print on (August 2026), with Ratoma keeping a small reserve of secure paper for urgent cases such as new baccalauréat holders and people travelling for medical care, and serving applicants from any commune. The information gap has a cost attached: the state's own technical partner on the biometric civil-registration system has asked the ministries for a national campaign restating that biometric documents are free, unannounced inspections of enrolment centres and a freephone reporting line (July 2026), with no ministerial response recorded.

Where the service has moved online, power and connection are the gate before any of this. In Conakry, students seeking computer training and applicants submitting job applications through cybercafés cannot reliably finish the transaction, because both the electricity and the connection the cybercafé depends on are intermittent (August 2026). Guineans' rated access to public services scores 33.5 of 100, 33rd of 54 and near-flat across the decade (2023).

Digital divides

Guinea's score for equal socioeconomic opportunity fell 13.4 points over the decade to 23.9 of 100 in 2023, 45th of 54 African countries, dragging down an Inclusion & Equality measure that stands at 35.7 and 42nd of 54. The gap widening fastest is the one between Guineans, not the one between Guinea and its neighbours.

Inclusion work runs through a dedicated agency and targeted initiatives: the universal service and inclusion agency ANSUTEN and initiatives such as "200 Femmes dans les TIC" (2025), and a first women's hackathon run by the agency trained more than 130 young women in Conakry, Labé and Mamou (November 2025).

The physical prerequisites divide along the same line. Grid electricity reaches the great majority of urban households and only a small minority of rural ones (2021), a four-to-one gap that sets a ceiling on anything the network above it can deliver. The fibre backbone now reaches every administrative region, with unserved "white zones" still on the ministry's own list for 2026 (2025) — backbone coverage and household coverage being different things. Internet use remains a minority position nationally (2025), and the Ibrahim Index's internet and computers measure is among Guinea's ten weakest indicators (2023) despite a decade of improvement, so the divides described here are divisions of a small base.

Data

National statistics

The Ibrahim Index makes Capacity of the Statistical System Guinea's most improved public-administration measure, up 11.6 points over 2014-2023 to 38.9 of 100 in 2023 — a decade of gains that still leaves the country 38th of 54 on it.

The World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators show where that improvement has and has not reached: for 2023 the data products pillar sits in the 70-89 per cent band while data services and data sources are both down in the 20-49 per cent band, with data use and data infrastructure between them at 50-69 per cent. The office produces outputs; the raw material underneath them and the machinery for getting them to users are the weak ends.

The collection record explains the thin sources. Guinea has held a population census within the last ten years but conducted neither an agricultural census nor a business census in the last twenty, and its survey record over the decade to 2023 runs to three or more health surveys, two household surveys and one labour force survey, with no agricultural or business survey at all. The sectors that occupy most Guineans are the ones the state has counted least.

Administrative data leans the same way. Routine health reporting runs on DHIS2 across every health district, though in rural areas the figures start on paper and are delivered or typed up at the district health office (2025); police and gendarmerie case files are still written by hand into paper registers, the basis on which the security ministry compiled its last published statistical yearbook.

Open data

Guinea's Journal Officiel moved online in June 2025 as a free legal gazette, carrying more than 1,100 issues and over 6,000 legal texts.

Two Ibrahim Index measures pull against each other around it. Accessibility of Public Records stood at 33.1 of 100 in 2023, 23rd of 54 and up 6.6 points over 2014-2023, the stronger of the pair; Disclosure of Public Records is among Guinea's ten worst-scoring indicators at 17.3 of 100, 43rd of 54, having gained 1.5 points over the same decade. Records are becoming easier to reach for those who go looking, while the state has barely moved on volunteering them.

Machine-readable release is weak across the board rather than in particular places. On the 2024 Open Data Inventory, Guinea's strongest category is money and banking at 6 out of 10 and its weakest crime and justice at 2, with nothing reaching 7.

Across the twenty-two 2024 Open Data Inventory categories for which Guinea has a recorded score, the average is 4.2 out of 10 and twenty of the twenty-two fall between 3 and 5 — a flat, uniformly low profile rather than one with real strengths and real gaps.

What is genuinely open is sectoral rather than general: the mining cadastre has been a public online register of licence areas and holders since 2017, the central bank publishes payment-system time series, and the state digitalisation agency posts its interoperability rules. Individual arrangements are announced without their terms: neither the ONECI agreement on securing the identity register nor the GEME state-mission platform came with a stated value or timetable.

Use of satellite data

Guinea's government was working with the start-up FindMe to pilot digital addressing, to upgrade postal services and territorial connectivity (August 2025).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

Guinea's border data is wired outward: the PISCES X border control system, a largely biometric database installed at Conakry's international airport with United States embassy support, synchronises watch-list and immigration data with INTERPOL, IOM MIDAS and the US Customs and Border Protection targeting system (November 2024).

The other American position is in health data. USAID's Notre Santé programme committed about USD 29 million over 2023 to 2028, with components supporting the national health information systems, the DHIS2 implementation and health data governance (2023) — which places a foreign donor inside the design of the country's principal health reporting instrument rather than merely alongside it.

China activities

China's most concrete position in Guinea is a surveillance one: the Safe City urban surveillance and security programme is being built on a China Eximbank concessional loan, and puts CCTV, command centres and urban security management platforms into Guinean cities (2025). What it holds is camera footage of the street and the platform layer that indexes it.

The reach extends past Guinea's own borders to the regional body it sits in. The China-aid ECOWAS Headquarters Building in Abuja was handed over on 28 April 2026, presented by China's ambassador as an outcome of the Forum on China-Africa Cooperation. The seat of the Commission whose regional digital rules Guinea adopts is now a Chinese-built asset.

EU activities

Europe's newest commitment in Guinea is a cable. In May 2026 Guinea signed the construction and maintenance agreement for MEDUSA Africa, committing the country to a second submarine landing with the state landing-station operator GUILAB as landing party — which keeps the landing in state hands on a cable system designed to link southern Europe with North and West Africa and the Middle East.

The older European footprint sits closer to the citizen record. An EU-funded pilot run by the Belgian development agency Enabel digitised Guinea's civil registry in 10 communes, capturing more than 105,000 records, with DXC Technology as technical partner (2023). The identities of Guinean citizens in those communes were therefore first put into digital form under a European programme, by a commercial contractor, at a scale small enough that the national registry remains substantially undigitised.

Gulf/UAE activities

Guinea had no Gulf-financed or Gulf-operated digital infrastructure or platform presence as at August 2026.

India activities

Guinea had no Indian-financed or Indian-built digital infrastructure or platform presence as at August 2026.

Digital sovereignty

A year after it opened, the national data centre built to bring home state data hosted abroad at an estimated cost of nearly US$5 million a year still had no settled operator: in September 2026 the prime minister was looking for qualified staff and, if needed, an interim manager, and the digital ministry had set up a technical committee in July 2026 to examine COREX group's proposals for operating it.

The rule for where public data sits is still being studied: a World Bank-supported study on hosting public data and a sovereign cloud was presented to state bodies in May 2026, and drafting of a National Data Governance Strategy began in June 2026. The one binding transfer rule has no gatekeeper: the 2016 data protection law lets a controller transfer personal data to a non-ECOWAS state only with the Autorité de Protection des Données's authorisation and where that state's protection is equivalent or higher, and that authority has never been established.

The same ground is being offered from outside. In July 2026 the digital minister's talks with Huawei in China covered the national fibre network, a national data centre and a sovereign cloud, and are to lead to a memorandum and a framework agreement. Huawei is already the technology partner for the Safe City surveillance network, whose financing Guinea ratified by law in June 2026. The terms on which the Safe City network and the July 2026 memorandum with NG Tech Innovation on the identity register govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

Over foreign platforms the state has taken a lever of its own: the May 2026 decree on foreign digital services requires providers to appoint a local representative within 90 days and creates a platform to monitor foreign digital services used in Guinea.

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